

Trophy

Williams Completes the Double

A sixth Trophy-and-Jacket double in TEG history, delivered with the same calm that carried him through all four rounds.

Gregg Williams closed out TEG 15 by winning both the Trophy and the Green Jacket. It is the sixth double in the tournament's history, after TEG 2, TEG 4, TEG 11, TEG 13 and TEG 14.

The final round at Oitavos Dunes did not need to be spectacular, and duly wasn't. Williams led both races going in. He led both coming out. The Trophy gap went from 18 to 21, the Jacket gap from 17 to 29.

His best work came in three holes, from the 13th to the 15th. Three pars, not a gross shot dropped, 9 points banked. The last of them arrived on the easiest hole on the course,

which is exactly where a man in his position ought to be taking his profits. His round of 91 was also his best at Oitavos Dunes in two visits, two shots inside the mark he set there at TEG 8.

All of which flatters a round that was, by his own very recent standard, a decline. He had posted 44 stableford points in round three. In round four he managed 34. Ten points, gone. It mattered not at all. The cushion built earlier in the tournament absorbed the lot, and both titles came home regardless. He won the thing while visibly losing interest in it, which is the most authoritative way to win anything.

AT A GLANCE
Trophy Winner Gregg Williams
Green Jacket Gregg Williams
Wooden Spoon Alex Baker

Round Stableford
SN 36 GW 34 JB 30 JP 30 AB 28 DM 22
Round Gross
GW +20 JB +23 SN +28 AB +32 DM +33 JP +34

After R4 • Trophy
GW 157 SN 136 JP 135 JB 131 DM 125 AB 114
After R4 • Green Jacket
GW +63 JB +92 DM +93 JP +113 SN +128 AB +134

Stuart Neumann

Neumann's Best Round Ends in a Nine

A career-quality Stableford return took a wrong turn at the very last hole of the week.

Stuart Neumann assembled the best Stableford card of Tuesday's links round at Oitavos Dunes. His 36 points matched the field's top score and bettered anything else the group of six could manage. It should have stood as the highlight of round four.

He then found a way to undercut it at the very last hole. The 18th is a par four, ranked the second-hardest on the course. Neumann needed nine shots to get home. A quintuple bogey, zero points, delivered at the precise moment the card was being closed out.

The wider picture is no kinder. His best gross at Oitavos Dunes this TEG was 99. On his only previous visit he carded 95. Four strokes worse, then, and the step backwards was signed off in the most fitting manner available.

David Mullin

Mullin's Round to Forget

Two personal worsts in one afternoon, and a nervous look over the shoulder at the Wooden Spoon.

David Mullin's final round at Oitavos Dunes produced his worst Stableford score and his worst gross score of the TEG, in the same 18 holes. He returned 22 points, down from the 40 of the previous round, and signed for a gross 33 over par.

The damage arrived in two instalments. He opened with a quadruple bogey 8 at the 1st, a triple bogey at the 2nd and a double bogey at the 3rd. Nine shots gone in three holes, without a single net par to show for them. He steadied through the middle of the round, which in hindsight reads less like recovery and more like reconnaissance. The finish went bogey, double bogey, double bogey, then another quadruple bogey 8 at the 18th, a hole ranked the second-hardest on the course. Four holes, no net par, eight shots dropped from the 16th home. It was, by some distance, the worst round of his TEG.

John Patterson

Patterson's Ten at the First Sets the Tone

A calamitous start on the very first hole shaped the whole of Patterson's final round.

John Patterson's fourth round at Oitavos Dunes unravelled before it began. He took 10 on the par-4 1st, a sextuple bogey, on one of the harder holes on the course. A double bogey followed at the 2nd, then another at the par-3 3rd. Ten shots gone across three holes, not a net par among them.

Nothing improved. Between the 9th and 13th he shipped a further twelve shots, including a quadruple bogey 7 on the par-3 12th. At the par-4 17th he produced another quadruple bogey, this one an 8. The only calm came at the 15th and 16th, where back-to-back pars briefly stopped the bleeding, though by then the patient was past helping. It was Patterson's first visit to Oitavos Dunes. He leaves it with a gross of 105 and a firm opinion of the opening tee shot.

Records & Personal Bests

Notable achievements: TEG 15, Round 4

Personal Worsts

- David Mullin's worst round to date: 22 pts
- David Mullin's worst Gross round to date: +33
- David Mullin — 10 Stableford on the Back nine is a personal-worst Back nine Stableford